

ADAM EDUARD ANTHONY UPENIEKS

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Financial markets, asset pricing, news, attention & market efficiency.

EDUCATION

University of Calgary, Canada 2021–present
PhD in Finance

Bayes Business School, London, UK 2019–2020
MSc in Quantitative Finance — With Distinction (First-Class Honours, GPA 4.0)

University of Waterloo, Waterloo, Canada 2017–2019
MA in Economics

University of Waterloo, Waterloo, Canada 2012–2017
BA in Economics

WORKING PAPERS

Looking Away from the Market *Job Market Paper, sole-authored*

The CAPM fails unconditionally in empirical tests, but recent evidence that beta is priced comes from days dominated by systematic news. A growing literature shows that aggregate and firm-specific news are substitutes for investor attention; building on this, I study the opposite information environment: public idiosyncratic news. Using firm-level news from the Dow Jones Newswire and institutional attention from Bloomberg search activity, I identify states in which market-wide attention is anchored to publicly available idiosyncratic news. On such days, stock market beta is strongly related to average returns and the security market line is steep and positive. When attention is instead elevated but not explained by firm-specific news, the relation flattens or reverses. This relation holds for individual stocks and beta-sorted portfolios, survives removing earnings and macroeconomic announcement days, and is robust to other state variables known to affect CAPM performance. To rationalize these findings, I develop a general equilibrium model in which investors split a fixed attention budget between firm-specific public news and private signals about the market factor. Because firm-specific news is orthogonal to the factor, attention to it crowds out factor learning: posterior factor uncertainty rises with the share of attention on firm-level news, and investors demand a higher factor risk premium to bear it, steepening the security market line and tying the CAPM's success to the composition of attention rather than its level. Unconditional betas price returns on roughly 46% of trading days.

Beta Between the Headlines *sole-authored*

Revise and resubmit, Review of Asset Pricing Studies

The empirical security market line is far too flat relative to what the CAPM predicts. Using news articles from the Dow Jones Newswire, filtered through a large language model to retain only idiosyncratic news, I develop a new state variable that determines when the CAPM prices risk based on the level of idiosyncratic news in the cross section. When idiosyncratic news is scarce, the CAPM performs well, and the beta-return relationship is steep and positive. I show that the empirical failure of the CAPM reflects biased beliefs: firms exposed to the long or short side of many anomalies are mispriced, and the mispricing is distributed asymmetrically across beta-sorted portfolios. Idiosyncratic news corrects this mispricing in the direction of a flatter security market line, so beta is strongly and positively priced when idiosyncratic news is scarce.

Presented at: Financial Management Association Asia/Pacific Conference*, Alpine Finance Summit 2026* (poster), Southern Finance Association 2026*, European Financial Management Association 2026, French Finance Association 2026, Future Finance Festival, Global Finance Conference 2026, Financial Management and Accounting Research Conference 2026 (*scheduled).

Overreaction to Scarcity: Precautionary Demand and Oil Price Reversals

with Alexander David

Text-based measures of attention to oil demand and supply in the financial press both predict crude oil futures returns negatively over the following year while leading analysts to revise their price forecasts upward, the signature of belief overreaction. In contrast, the real economic activity index of Kilian (2009), the canonical measure of realized demand, positively predicts future returns and analyst forecast revisions. To locate the difference we decompose the analytical content of the EIA's monthly Short-Term Energy Outlook into the structural channels of Kilian (2009) using a two-stage large language model pipeline, reading directly the precautionary demand that the structural literature identifies as an unobservable expectations shock. Aggregate demand and supply content are updated rationally: they move forecasts, leave subsequent returns unaffected, and move production, inventories, and drilling as a structural framework would predict. Precautionary demand content moves forecasts up and subsequent returns down, forecasts returns out of sample, and is followed within a quarter by net selling from speculators and reduced hedging by producers. Expectations about future scarcity, rather than realized demand or supply, drive the oil price movements that subsequently reverse.

Presented at: 10th Commodity Markets Winter Workshop 2027* (* scheduled).

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2027: 10th Commodity Markets Winter Workshop* (* scheduled)

2026: Université de Sherbrooke (research seminar), Financial Management Association Asia/Pacific Conference*, Alpine Finance Summit* (poster), Southern Finance Association*, European Financial Management Association, French Finance Association, Future Finance Festival, Global Finance Conference, Financial Management and Accounting Research Conference (* scheduled)

CONFERENCE DISCUSSIONS

2026: Financial Management Association Asia/Pacific Conference*, Alpine Finance Summit*, Southern Finance Association*, European Financial Management Association, French Finance Association, Future Finance Festival, Global Finance Conference, Financial Management and Accounting Research Conference (* scheduled)

HONORS & AWARDS

Marion and Janet Forbes Scholarship (\$16,000) 2026

Alberta Graduate Excellence Scholarship (\$11,000), University of Calgary

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor — Haskayne School of Business 2024

BA — Futures and Options (FNCE 445), student rating 4.6/5

Teaching Assistant — Haskayne School of Business 2021–2024

- PhD — Empirical Corporate Finance (FNCE 775, Prof. Pablo Moran)
- DBA — Empirical Methods (MGST 772, Prof. Pablo Moran)
- MBA — Advanced Topics in Corporate Finance (FNCE 661, Prof. Ari Pandes)
- BA — Futures and Options (FNCE 445, Prof. KJ Choi)
- BA — Investments (FNCE 443, Prof. Miguel Palacios)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Hiring Committee Member

Assistant Professor in Quantum Finance, Haskayne School of Business 2025

Teaching Professor in Finance, Haskayne School of Business 2024

Referee

FMA Asia/Pacific Conference

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Ontario Ministry of Finance — Financial Risk Analyst, Toronto, Canada	2018–2019
Universität Hamburg — Research Intern (Vensim), Hamburg, Germany	2017–2018

CODING & SOFTWARE SKILLS

Strong: Python, R

Experienced: MATLAB, VBA, Stata, OxMetrics, Vensim, Mathematica, Dynare

MISCELLANEOUS

- Cordon Bleu — Certificate in Pastry Baking, Paris, France (2019)
- Rowing — Head of the Charles Regatta, 14/28, Boston, United States (2015)
- Running — San Francisco Marathon, 358/822, United States (2025)

REFERENCES

Prof. Miguel Palacios (Supervisor)

Associate Professor of Finance

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Prof. Alexander David (Co-supervisor)

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Rotman School of Management

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